Social and Educational thoughts (SPE)

1. Madan Mohan Malviya

Key Points / Facts

1. Early Life & Education

- **Born 25th December 1861, in Allahabad (Prayagraj).**
- **Family background: Saraswat Brahmin, father was a Sanskrit scholar & preacher.**
- **Values inherited: morality, spirituality, discipline, service to society.**
- **Education: Sanskrit, Muir Central College (English + Western thought) → shaped his nationalist philosophy.**

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2. Contributions to Education

- **Founded Banaras Hindu University (BHU) in 1916.**
- **Vision: Blend modern scientific learning + traditional Indian knowledge.**
- **Slogan: "Sarv-vidya ki Rajdhani" (Capital of all knowledge).**
- **Raised funds across India (rajas, businessmen, British govt).**
- **BHU = one of Asia's largest universities, legacy of academic + ethical learning.**

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3. Political & Social Contributions

- **Joined Indian National Congress in 1886, President 4 times (1909, 1918, 1932, 1933).**
- **Advocate of non-violent nationalism.**
- **Hindu Mahasabha (1906) founder, but stood for inter-religious harmony.**
- **Attended Round Table Conference, 1931 (London), argued for independence.**

- **Law career: Defended nationalists (notably Chauri Chaura case → saved hundreds from death penalty).**
- **Journalism: Edited *Hindustan* (Hindi weekly), co-founded *The Leader* (English daily).**

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4. Ethical Legacy

- **Called "Mahamana" by Mahatma Gandhi.**
- **Social reforms: Anti-untouchability, women's education, inclusivity in BHU.**
- **Promoted communal harmony: Hindus, Muslims, all communities together.**
- **Ethics in profession:**
  - **Lawyer: Never charged poor/political prisoners.**
  - **Educator: Focused on character-building, not just academics.**
- **Core values: Integrity, honesty, justice, equality, tolerance, service.**
- **Famous quote: *"A nation will be great in exact proportion to the purity and excellence of its women."***

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5. Recognition

- **Honored as Mahamana (by Gandhi).**
- **Bharat Ratna (2014, posthumous).**

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6. Conclusion

- **Malaviya was a freedom fighter, educationist, reformer, and moral leader.**
- **Legacy: education + ethics + unity = national progress.**
- **Message for today: Leadership must be value-based, not materialistic.**

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2. Gandhi JI

1. Introduction

- **Mahatma Gandhi (1869–1948) led India's freedom movement.**
- **Believed in non-violence (Ahimsa) and truth (Satya).**
- **His ideas went beyond politics: focused on society and education.**

2. Gandhi's Educational Philosophy (Nai Talim / Basic Education)

- **Learning through craft – practical work like spinning, farming, weaving.**
- **Head, Heart, and Hand – education should develop mind, character, and skills.**
- **Self-reliance and labor – respect for all work, "earn while you learn."**
- **Mother tongue – local languages strengthen understanding and culture.**
- **Moral & spiritual education – values of truth, non-violence, simplicity.**

3. Gandhi's Social Philosophy

- **Sarvodaya (welfare of all) – upliftment of the poor and marginalized.**
- **Against untouchability – called Dalits "Harijans" (Children of God).**
- **Women's empowerment – supported education and equality for women.**
- **Simple living & Swadeshi – use of local goods, self-reliance.**
- **Communal harmony & non-violence – peace among religions, conflict resolution through dialogue.**

4. Influences on Gandhi

- **Indian Scriptures – Bhagavad Gita, Upanishads (truth, selfless work).**

- **Jainism & Buddhism – non-violence, compassion.**
- **Western Thinkers – Tolstoy (love, peace), Ruskin (social justice), Thoreau (civil disobedience).**

5. Relevance Today

- **Value-based education – counter to marks-only focus.**
- **Unity in diversity – peace among religions and cultures.**
- **Sustainable living – wise use of resources, simple lifestyle.**
- **Peace & non-violence – dialogue instead of conflict.**

6. Conclusion

- **Gandhi promoted truth, equality, hard work, and care for all.**
- **His legacy inspires honesty, peace, and service.**
- **Students/teachers can follow him by:**
    - **Community service**
    - **Respecting work**
    - **Simple living**
    - **Kindness and fairness**
    - **Practicing peace and truth daily**

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3. Rabinder Naath tagore

Introduction

- **Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941): Poet, writer, philosopher, painter.**
- **Nobel Prize in Literature (1913) for *Gitanjali* — first non-European winner.**
- **Composed India's national anthem (*Jana Gana Mana*) and Bangladesh's (*Amar Sonar Bangla*).**
- **Founded Visva-Bharati University, blending Eastern and Western learning.**
- **Advocated peace, unity, global harmony, and opposed British colonial rule.**

Social Philosophy

1. **Freedom & Equality**
    - **Freedom = liberation of the mind from ignorance, not just political independence.**
    - **Critic of caste system and social injustice.**
    - **Opposed aggressive nationalism; promoted universal humanism.**
2. **Reform & Rural Development**
    - **Founded Sriniketan for rural reconstruction.**
    - **Emphasized self-sufficiency, community cooperation, practical training (agriculture, crafts, healthcare).**
3. **Unity Across Religions & Cultures**
    - **Saw diversity as enrichment, not conflict.**
    - **Visva-Bharati symbolized his dream of a unified world culture.**

Educational Philosophy

1. **Nature in Education – Learning outside classrooms; nature as a teacher.**
2. **Creativity & Arts – Music, drama, painting = essential for growth, not extras.**
3. **Criticism of British System – Colonial system produced clerks, not thinkers.**
4. **Freedom in Learning – Encouraged curiosity, self-inquiry, hands-on learning at Santiniketan.**

Legacy

- **Modern Education Influence – Inspired methods beyond rote learning; focus on nature, arts, critical thinking, social responsibility.**
- **Institutions Inspired – *Visva-Bharati University* is the prime example; many schools worldwide adopted similar open, creative models.**

Conclusion

- **Tagore's vision = universal humanism, equality, unity, and holistic education.**
- **Believed true education must nurture mind + spirit + humanity.**

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4. Swami Vivekanand

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1. Introduction

- Swami Vivekananda (1863–1902): monk, philosopher, patriot.
- Famous for 1893 Chicago speech at World Parliament of Religions.
- Core ideas: **religious tolerance, national pride, selfless service, education, nation-building, human upliftment**.

2. Early Life

- Born **Narendra Nath Datta** (12 Jan 1863, Kolkata).
- Father: Vishwanath Datta (lawyer); Mother: Bhuvaneshwari Devi (spiritual).
- Interests: music, gymnastics, philosophy.
- Education: Presidency & Scottish Church College.
- Inspired by Indian scriptures + Western thought.
- Disciple of **Sri Ramakrishna** after profound spiritual experience.

3. Educational Philosophy

- **Education = manifestation of perfection already in man.**
- **Man-making education:** physical, intellectual, and spiritual growth.
- **Character building:** courage, discipline, self-belief.
- **Practical learning:** skills for real life, not rote learning.
- **Women's education:** essential for world's welfare.
- **Self-reliance:** education must make individuals independent.

4. Social Philosophy

- **Service to humanity:** "Daridra Narayana Seva" (serve the poor as God).

- **Religious harmony:** unity of all faiths.
- **Youth empowerment:** youth = backbone of the nation.
- **Social equality:** against caste discrimination and untouchability.
- Quote: *"Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached."*

5. Chicago Speech, 1893

- Began with: *"Sisters and Brothers of America"* → standing ovation.
- Core message: all religions lead to the same truth.
- Quotes:
    - Proud of Hinduism's tolerance and universal acceptance.
    - Condemned fanaticism and sectarianism.
    - Compared religions to rivers leading to the same sea.

6. Rewards and Legacy

National:

- 12 January = **National Youth Day** (since 1984).
- Honoured with stamps; teachings in textbooks & civil services.

Global:

- Known as *"Cyclonic Monk of India."*
- Lectured across USA & Europe.
- Cultural centres worldwide in his name.

Ramakrishna Mission (1897): works in **health, education, disaster relief, rural development**.

Memorials:

- Vivekananda Rock Memorial, Kanyakumari.

- Statues in India & abroad.
- UNESCO praised his peace and tolerance philosophy.

7. Conclusion

- Visionary who merged **spirituality with nation-building**.
- Emphasized: **character-building education, unity in diversity, service, courage, and truth**.
- His famous call: *“Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached.”*
